29 October 2026

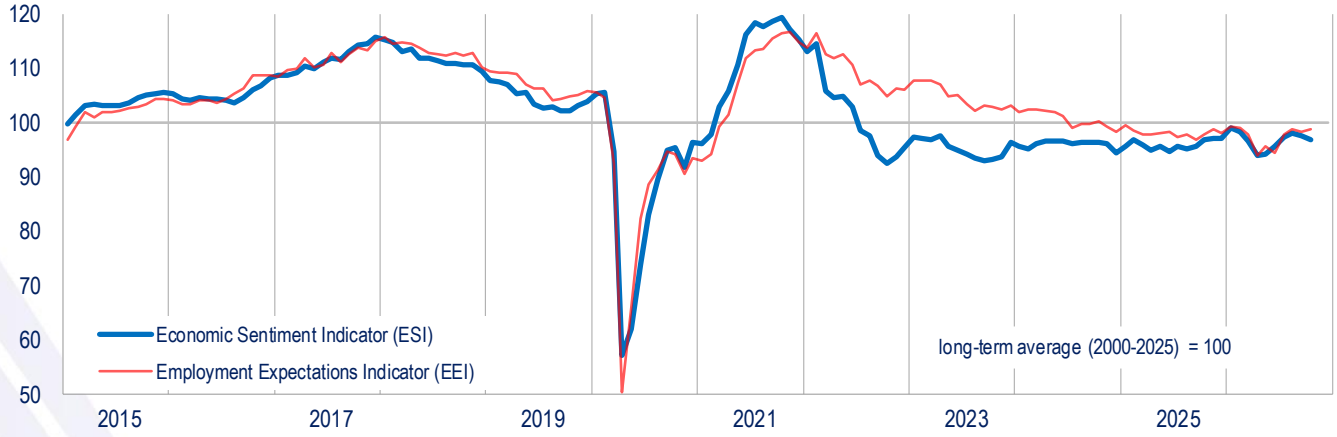
Business and consumer survey results for October 2026

Economic Sentiment down, Employment Expectations up in both the EU and the euro area

In October 2026, the *Economic Sentiment Indicator (ESI)* declined for the second consecutive month in both the EU and the euro area, falling by 0.6 points to 96.9 in both areas.[1] By contrast, the *Employment Expectations Indicator* (EEI) picked up in both areas compared with September (EU: +0.6 points to 98.9, euro area: +0.7 points to 98.2).

EU developments

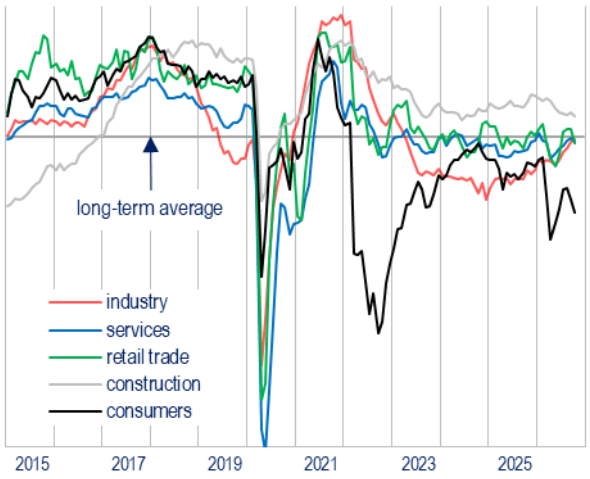
Graph 1: **EU Economic sentiment & Employment expectations**



source: European Commission services

The downturn in the ESI was driven by lower confidence in all sectors except industry, which saw a marginal improvement. Results are mixed among the largest economies: the ESI declined considerably in the Netherlands (-3.4), edged down in Germany (-0.7) and Spain (-0.5), increased moderately in Italy (+0.8) and remained broadly stable in Poland (+0.2) and France (+0.1).

Graph 2: **EU confidence indicators[2]**



Industry confidence edged up further (+0.3), driven by an improvement in managers' assessments of the *stocks of finished products.* Managers' *production expectations* and assessments of the *current level of overall order books* remained broadly stable. Among the questions not entering the confidence indicator, managers' assessment of *production changes in recent months* and *export order books* improved markedly. **Confidence in services** declined (-0.7), reflecting managers' more negative views on both *demand* and the *business situation* over the past 3 months. By contrast, *demand expectations* for the next 3 months improved. **Consumer confidence** weakened for the second month in a row (-1.2), driven by a deterioration in consumers' assessments of their *household's past and expected financial situation*, as well as a decline in their *intentions to make major purchases*. Meanwhile, consumers' *expectations about the general economic situation in their country* remained largely unchanged. Similarly, **retail trade confidence** dropped markedly (-1.7), mainly reflecting retailers' more negative assessment of *the past business situation*. Assessments of the *future business situation* and the *volume*

[1] With this release, the September results have been revised following updated French business survey data and the re-inclusion of Italian consumer survey data in the calculation of the European aggregates. The Italian consumer data are subject to a structural break between August and September 2026.

[2] The graph presents standardised series to correct for differences in means and standard deviations.